

2024

ZALORA

Zalora Boosts Site Performance by 46% by Migrating its Content Delivery Network to AWS

Zalora migrated to Amazon CloudFront in just two weeks to lower IT costs and website response times, helping the e-tailer meet new budget guidelines while better serving customers.

[Overview](#) | [Opportunity](#) | [Solution](#) | [Outcome](#) | [AWS Services Used](#)

49%

lower CDN cost

Up to 46%

faster site response times

2 weeks

migration timeline

Improved agility

Streamlines operations and boosts net



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Overview

[Zalora](#) is an Asian fashion and lifestyle ecommerce retailer with 59 million monthly site visits. The company reduced IT costs and improved performance by switching from a third-party content delivery network to AWS.



Zalora now uses [Amazon CloudFront](#) as a low-latency CDN, [AWS WAF](#) to secure access to its content, [AWS Shield](#) for DDoS protection, and [Amazon Route 53](#) as a DNS service. By migrating its CDN to AWS, Zalora has reduced costs by 49 percent and lowered response times by up to 46 percent to serve its customers faster.



Opportunity | Complying with New Budget Mandate

For more than a decade, Zalora has provided fashion-savvy customers with a wide variety of popular brands shipped direct to their door. Zalora is a fashion and lifestyle ecommerce retailer in Southeast Asia, serving six national markets. As a customer-first brand, Zalora is constantly seeking new ways to improve its shopping experience. For years, Zalora has run its customer-facing IT architecture on Amazon Web Services (AWS), valuing the agility and scalability of the platform.

As part of Zalora's transition to a more sustainable business model following the pandemic, the business decided to reevaluate and streamline its technology stack. Recognizing the need for cost reduction, Zalora chose to optimize its third-party content delivery network (CDN). It sought a more cost-effective CDN that could offer a better price-to-performance ratio and easier customization. Zalora's leaders knew migrating its CDN to the cloud would save costs and improve performance, but the company only had two weeks to migrate because of an expiring contract with its previous CDN provider.

Solution | Migrating with AWS Support in Just 2 Weeks

As a long-standing customer of [AWS Enterprise Support](#), Zalora consulted with AWS about testing Amazon CloudFront as a low-latency CDN. Key migration goals were lower cost, higher availability, and improved site response times. Particularly in Indonesia and the Philippines—where it has customers across thousands of islands—Zalora wanted to at least maintain site latency for website views and transactions.

With Zalora's previous CDN provider, it was difficult to evaluate and procure new services because of the administrative and paperwork burden required to make changes. In contrast, Amazon CloudFront offered the opportunity to immediately start testing with no upfront commitment. Kenichi Otsuka, director of site reliability engineering at Zalora, ran a proof of concept (POC) comparing Amazon CloudFront to the incumbent CDN and another cloud CDN provider. "With Amazon CloudFront, response time analyses from each of the six Southeast Asian countries we operate in showed lower response times," he confirms.

Satisfied with the performance of Amazon CloudFront after two POCs, Zalora signed a multi-year contract with AWS. The company also received dedicated support from the [AWS Professional Services](#) team, solution architects, technical account managers, and specialists, with a daily stand-up meeting to ensure migration success within its two-week timeline.

In addition to Amazon CloudFront, Zalora implemented AWS WAF to protect its web applications and Amazon Route 53 as a highly available domain name system (DNS) web service. The company uses [AWS Shield Advanced](#), a managed DDoS protection service that safeguards applications running on AWS. Using Amazon CloudFront also provides the convenience of using [AWS Certificate Manager](#) (ACM) for public-facing SSL certificates without going through a lengthy procurement process. Otsuka says, "We optimized infrastructure configuration management in Terraform for AWS, which covers Amazon CloudFront, AWS WAF, Amazon Route53, and even SSL certificates."

Outcome | Achieving Budget Targets with Lower Latency in All Markets

The migration to Amazon CloudFront led to a 49 percent cost reduction for Zalora. In particular, the company now saves thousands of dollars each month on data transfer expenses, because Amazon CloudFront does not impose charges for data transfer out from AWS origins. Zalora also benefits from the pay-as-you-go pricing model of Amazon CloudFront, which aligns well with its business model as an online retailer with fluctuating traffic patterns, including peak shopping periods like 11.11.

Migration to AWS has also reduced operational overhead. With its CDN, firewall, and DNS centralization, Zalora has streamlined operations for easier management and oversight. Engineers can manage all of these services through the same dashboard and control center from which they manage other aspects of Zalora's infrastructure,



boosting IT efficiency. Otsuka says, “Switching to Amazon CloudFront streamlined operations and boosted network performance.”

The company has also achieved lower latency, with response times being 46 percent faster on average. Even in multi-island countries like Indonesia and the Philippines, which had the strongest latency concerns, system response times have improved by 11 percent and 23 percent, respectively. Amazon CloudFront uses more than 550 points of presence that AWS maintains throughout the globe to ensure low latency for customers abroad.

About Zalora

Founded in 2012, Zalora is an ecommerce fashion and lifestyle retailer in Southeast Asia. The e-tailer has presence in Singapore, Indonesia, Malaysia, Brunei, the Philippines, Hong Kong, and Taiwan, with over 59 million platform visits per month.

AWS Services Used

Amazon CloudFront

Amazon CloudFront is a content delivery network (CDN) service built for high performance, security, and developer convenience.

[Learn more »](#)

AWS WAF

AWS WAF helps you protect against common web exploits and bots that can affect availability, compromise security, or consume excessive resources.

[Learn more »](#)

AWS Certificate Manager

Use AWS Certificate Manager (ACM) to provision, manage, and deploy public and private SSL/TLS certificates for use with AWS services and your internal connected resources. ACM removes the time-consuming manual process of purchasing, uploading, and renewing SSL/TLS certificates.

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AWS Professional Services

The AWS Professional Services organization is a global team of experts that can help you realize your desired business outcomes when using the AWS Cloud.

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